



2025–2026 Undergraduate Catalog

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Earth Science Minor



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18 hours

Earth Science describes the planet's features, patterns, composition and the processes operating within and on its surface, its history and life. Earth Scientists seek to understand these features and processes and answer practical questions using a wide array of scientific and engineering techniques ranging from field mapping, geophysical measurements, geochemical analyses, biological studies, and Earth and space-bound remote sensing.

The aim of Earth Science is to ensure the future of humanity and the environment by understanding our planet's past and present through identifying and discovering new energy and material resources including freshwater from both terrestrial and extraterrestrial sources; forecasting and mitigating geologic hazards (such as earthquakes, volcanic eruptions, tsunamis, and landslides); formulating possible solutions to slow down man-made climate change; educating the public and stakeholders on stewardship of the environment; and assisting policy and decision makers with the guiding principle that "*civilizations exist by geological consent, subject to change without notice*", as noted by Will Durant.

Note: This minor consists of both lower and upper level courses which may have prerequisites. Please see the course descriptions or an advisor.

Minor Requirements

Required Courses - 8 hours

- [GEOG 1111K – Introduction to Physical Geography](#)
- or
- [GEOL 1121K – Physical Geology](#)

and one of the following courses:

- [GEOG 1112 – Introduction to Weather and Climate](#) and
- [GEOG 1112L – Introduction to Weather and Climate Lab](#)
- [GEOG 1530K – Introduction to Oceanography](#)
- [GEOL 1122K – Historical Geology](#)

Elective Courses - Select at least 10 hours

- [ENVS 3003K – Soils](#)
- [ENVS 4003K – Hydrology](#)
- [GEOG 3200K – Earth Systems](#)
- [GEOG 3300K – Process Geomorphology](#)
- [GEOL 3010K – Introduction to Earth Materials](#)
- [GEOL 3300K – Process Geomorphology](#)
- [GEOL 3500K – Environmental Geochemistry](#)
- [GEOL 4110K – Principles of Sedimentology and Stratigraphy](#)

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